

Product UX/UI Evaluation & Comprehensive Audit Report

GradRight Application Analysis — Focus on First-Time User Experience

Hi Team,

This evaluation report is designed to be sharp, straight to the point, and structured for fast review. You can quickly go through all identified breakdowns without losing time, as every issue is captured in a short, concise, and focused format. To support recruiters and application testers in reproducing and fixing these problems immediately, I have provided a detailed, step-by-step reproduction path for each item. Additionally, all visual evidence has been compiled into a separate folder: **01_UX_Screen_Recordings**, where individual screen recordings are available for every single bug found.

During my deep-dive testing of the latest version of the app, I logged a total of **10 distinct UX and UI bugs** across core workflows. While all 10 issues disrupt the interface, I have isolated the **Top 3 Critical UX Breakdowns**. These three are major friction points that break basic navigation habits, cause severe layout failures, or terminate active user sessions completely—leading to immediate drop-offs for first-time students.

TOP 3 CRITICAL UX ISSUES (HIGH IMPACT ON FIRST-TIME USERS)

1. App Exits Completely on Swipe-Back Gesture from On-Campus Page (Critical Flow Break)

Why it hurts first-time users: When a new user explores the "On-Campus Programs" page and uses the standard system swipe-back gesture to go home, the app closes completely instead of returning to the dashboard. This breaks basic navigation habits, makes the app feel completely broken, and forces users to restart the app, leading to immediate drop-offs.

2. Profile Menu Fails to Auto-Dismiss & Breaks Navigation Paths from Community Page (Dead Ends)

Why it hurts first-time users: The profile side-menu has severe lifecycle flaws. If a user clicks an item, it changes the background screen but leaves the menu frozen on top, forcing manual closure. Worse, if they try to navigate while on the Community page, the "Saved Programs" tab is completely dead, and the "Notifications" screen locks up, preventing them from opening any alerts. This creates massive frustration and structural dead ends.

3. Missing Content Moderation & Broken "Self-Reporting" in Community (Safety & Trust Risk)

Why it hurts first-time users: The Community space has zero text filters or moderation systems, allowing spam or inappropriate content to sit out in the open. Additionally, users cannot edit or delete their own posts. Instead, the UI forces them to "Report" their own content to get rid of it. This setup is highly confusing and damages the credibility of the platform right away.

COMPLETE 10-BUG AUDIT LOG

Bug 1: No Content Moderation, No Delete/Edit Option, and Broken "Self-Reporting" in Community

Reported Issue / Bug: The Community section has zero safety controls—there are no bad-word filters or content moderation systems, allowing anyone to post inappropriate or spammy content. Additionally, users cannot edit or delete their own posts/comments. Instead, the app bizarrely allows users to "Report" their own posts and comments, which is completely illogical.

Bug 2: App Exits Completely on Swipe-Back Gesture from On-Campus Page

Reported Issue / Bug: In the "On-Campus Programs" section, using the system's swipe-back gesture to return to the Home screen fails to navigate correctly. Instead of taking the user back to the Home page, the app immediately exits and closes entirely. This severely disrupts the user flow, making the app feel broken, and persists even on the latest updated version of the app.

Bug 3: Filter Count Badge Does Not Match Selected Filters and Fails to Reset

Reported Issue / Bug: On the "On-Campus Programs" page, the numeric badge next to the "Filters" option is completely desynced from the user's actual actions. Applying or changing a filter causes the badge count to change to an incorrect number that does not match the count of selected filters. Furthermore, performing a filter reset fails to clear the badge back to zero.

Bug 4: "Compare" Panel Leaks/Persists When Navigating Away from On-Campus Programs (Working Fine on Online Programs)

Reported Issue / Bug: The comparison panel state leaks across screens specifically on the "On-Campus Programs" flow. Selecting programs for comparison on the On-Campus page and then navigating to "Saved Programs" fails to dismiss the "Compare between" overlay, causing it to incorrectly persist on a completely different screen. Conversely, this feature works perfectly on the "Online Programs" flow, where the panel is dismissed correctly upon navigation.

Bug 5: Sorting Options Do Not Work Properly on On-Campus Programs (Works Fine on Online Programs)

Reported Issue / Bug: The sorting functionality on the "On-Campus Programs" page is completely broken. Selecting and applying a sorting preference (such as "Fees: Low to High") fails to reorder the program list, leaving the results completely unsorted. In contrast, this same sorting logic works perfectly fine and updates the list correctly under the "Online Programs" section.

Bug 6: Profile Menu Fails to Auto-Dismiss & Breaks Navigation Paths from Community Page

Reported Issue / Bug: The Profile slide-out overlay menu has major navigation and lifecycle flaws. First, tapping an item from the menu navigates to the target page but fails to auto-dismiss the menu, leaving it frozen on top of the screen until closed manually. Second, if a user is currently on the "Community" page, the menu's navigation logic breaks entirely: tapping "Saved Programs" is completely dead and ignores the user's action, while tapping "Notifications" opens the notification page but completely fails to let the user click or open any specific notification inside it.

Bug 7: Graddie Onboarding Accepts Expired Intake Dates Without Warning

Reported Issue / Bug: The Graddie AI onboarding profile setup lacks vital date-validation logic. The system allows users to select expired intake windows (such as "Jan to Mar 2026") without displaying any warning or error message. Because this date is used downstream to generate university recommendations, accepting a past intake window corrupts the data model and leads to inaccurate or irrelevant program recommendations.

Bug 8: Graddie AI Chat Lacks 'Clear Chat' or 'New Chat' Functionality

Reported Issue / Bug: The Graddie AI interface provides no option for users to reset their conversation history or initiate a fresh thread. As a user continues to interact with the assistant over time, messages indefinitely accumulate with no method to clear them. This creates a cluttered UI and makes it incredibly difficult to switch contexts or follow a new line of query without historical data muddying the chat.

Bug 9: Quick-Filter Tags ("Valued Partner" & "AI Recommended") Fail to Filter Results on On-Campus Programs

Reported Issue / Bug: The quick-filter tags located at the top of the "On-Campus Programs" page are completely broken. Tapping on specific category tags like "Valued Partner" or "AI Recommended" fails to isolate or refine the program list according to the selected label. Instead, the page continues to display all available programs mixed together. This represents a core filtering failure where clickable UI tags do not execute their intended functions, misleading the user about the data currently displayed on screen.

Bug 10: Primary Navigation Bar Fails to Clear and Persists on the "Saved Programs" Screen

Reported Issue / Bug: The global bottom navigation bar (comprising Home, On-Campus, Online Programs, and Ask AI) exhibits a critical persistent state leak when entering sub-navigation screens. When a user opens the dedicated "Saved Programs" view, the application fails to hide the main hub's persistent navigation elements. Instead, the global navigation bar remains incorrectly anchored over the bottom edge of the screen, with the "On-Campus" tab indicator remaining erroneously highlighted. This leaks active view components across unrelated layers, reduces useful screen real estate, and introduces severe architectural state confusion into the core navigation stack.

TESTER'S & RECRUITER'S GUIDE: STEPS TO REPRODUCE EACH BUG

Steps to Reproduce Bug 1:

1. Go to the "Community" tab and create a new post or write a comment.
 2. Try to find an "Edit" or "Delete" button to modify or remove your post—there is none, meaning you are stuck with it forever.
 3. Click on the three dots (menu) on your own post or comment (observe that the only option available is "Report", meaning the app allows you to report yourself).
 4. Test posting random gibberish or inappropriate test words (observe that the app immediately publishes it without any automatic filtering, blocking, or moderation).
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 2:

1. Open the app and navigate to the On-Campus Programs page.
 2. Use the system's swipe-back gesture (from either the left or right edge of the screen) to try and return to the Home page.
 3. Observe that instead of navigating back to the Home screen, the app immediately terminates and closes.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 3:

1. Navigate to the On-Campus Programs page and observe the default number shown next to the Filters option (e.g., showing "6" initially).
 2. Open the filter panel, select and apply a filter, and close the panel.
 3. Observe that the badge count updates to an incorrect number that does not match the number of active filters selected.
 4. Open the filter panel again and click on the "Reset" option to clear all filters.
 5. Observe that after resetting, the filter badge still fails to return to zero.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 4:

1. Go to the On-Campus Programs page.
 2. Select any two programs to add them to the comparison panel.
 3. Without starting the comparison, tap on the Saved Programs tab.
 4. Observe that the "Compare between" panel incorrectly remains visible on the screen, carrying over to the Saved page.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 5:

1. Go to the On-Campus Programs page.
 2. Open the Filters and Sort menu, select the sorting option "Fees: Low to High", and click apply.
 3. Scroll through the program list and observe that the program fees are not arranged in ascending order (the sorting has failed to apply).
 4. (For Contrast) Navigate to the Online Programs page, apply the exact same "Fees: Low to High" sorting option, and observe that the list updates and sorts correctly.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 6:

Issue 1: Menu Fails to Auto-Dismiss

1. Tap on the Profile icon to open the slide-out menu.
2. Tap on Notifications and select a specific notification.
3. Observe that the app changes the background page to the correct target, but the Profile menu remains stuck open on top of it, forcing a manual click on the 'X' button to clear it.

Issue 2: Broken Navigation & Dead Clicks from Community Page

1. Open the Profile menu and tap Community to load the community section.
 2. While remaining on the Community page, open the Profile menu again.
 3. Tap on Saved Programs (Observe that the action is completely dead/ignored and fails to navigate away from Community).
 4. Open the Profile menu again and tap Notifications (Observe that the notification page opens, but trying to tap on any specific notification inside the page does absolutely nothing).
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 7:

1. Open the app and begin the Graddie AI onboarding/profile setup flow.
 2. Proceed to the step where the app asks: "When do you want to start your Master's?".
 3. Select an intake timeline that has already passed (e.g., "Jan to Mar 2026").
 4. Observe that the app accepts the expired selection with no validation block or warning, allowing the user to complete the profile setup with invalid data.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 8:

1. Open the app and navigate to the Graddie AI chat interface.
 2. Interact with the chat assistant by sending a series of messages or completing an inquiry thread.
 3. Attempt to look for a "Trash icon", "Reset", "Clear Chat", or "New Chat" button within the chat window or its contextual settings menu to wipe the history.
 4. Observe that no such option exists, forcing the user's past conversation history to continuously accumulate and mix into any subsequent new queries.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 9:

1. Navigate to the On-Campus Programs page.
 2. Tap on the "Valued Partner" filter tag displayed at the top of the results list.
 3. Observe that the list fails to filter down and still displays all programs, including "AI Recommended" and non-partner items mixed together.
 4. Tap on the "AI Recommended" filter tag.
 5. Observe the same failure—the program list does not isolate the AI-recommended items and fails to update the results layout.
-

Steps to Reproduce Bug 10:

1. Navigate to the "On-Campus Programs" or "Online Programs" listing feed and bookmark a specific course card.
 2. Open the user profile drawer or primary menu and select the "Saved Programs" path to open the dedicated bookmarks view.
 3. Observe the bottom boundary of the interface: the global primary navigation bar fails to clear its layout context and remains visible over the "Saved Programs" view.
 4. Note that the "On-Campus" icon option remains visually highlighted as the active state, despite the user having fully navigated away from that page stack.
-

SUMMARY & PRODUCT APPROACH

As an engineering graduate building a career path across Product Management, Product Analysis, Product Associate, Data Analyst, Business Analyst, or Research Analyst positions, I approach product audits with a balance of technical execution and rigorous user empathy. An exceptional mobile application relies on predictable states, bulletproof navigation handling, and reliable search controls. Resolving these 10 distinct issues ensures GradRight offers a predictable, highly cohesive, and professional ecosystem for incoming global students.

I look forward to discussing how my detailed QA metrics, product intuition, and rigorous tracking methodologies can drive quality outcomes for your team.

Best regards,

Swasthik